

ENG515 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 05

(ENG515)Teaching of Reading andWriting Skills

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

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Lesson-01

INTRODUCTION TO THE COURSE

Topic-001: Introduction to the Course

What is the main focus of this course?

The main focus of this course is for teachers of English as L2 or EFL, with a practical emphasis on techniques and a balanced approach.

What is the framework of the course, and how is it divided?

The course is divided into four strands: meaning-focused input, output, language-focused learning, and fluency development.

Topic-002: Receptive & Productive Skills

What are receptive skills in language learning, and give examples?

Receptive skills include listening and reading, known as passive skills. An example is starting with understanding new items before moving on to use.

What are productive skills, and how are they related to receptive skills?

Productive skills include speaking and writing, known as active skills. They are interrelated with receptive skills, with reading having a strong impact.

Topic-003: Four Strands of Language Teaching

What are the four strands of language teaching covered in this course?

The four strands are meaning-focused input, meaning-focused output, language-focused learning, and fluency development.

What are the principles behind meaning-focused input, and how are they applied in teaching?

Meaning-focused input involves reading for various purposes, appropriate to the level, and related to other skills. The course should involve listening, speaking, and writing activities related to reading.

What is the goal of language-focused learning, and how is it achieved?

Language-focused learning aims to develop the skills and knowledge needed for effective reading. This is achieved through training in reading strategies and making learners familiar with text structures.

What is the purpose of fluency development, and what strategies are used?

The purpose of fluency development is to help learners develop fluency in reading through familiar material, speed reading in word recognition, motivation, and access to interesting texts.

Topic-004: What is Reading?

How is reading described in recent research, and what is its nature?

Recent research describes reading as a conscious and unconscious thinking process where the reader reconstructs the meaning of a text by comparing it with prior knowledge.

What are the two key aspects of reading according to Nation (2005)?

Reading involves decoding and comprehension, where readers recognize language and construct meaning through a comprehension process.

What is emphasized in the comprehension process, and what role does prior knowledge play?

The comprehension process emphasizes recognizing language and constructing meaning, which is an interactive process that relies on the reader's experience and prior knowledge.

Lesson-02

TEACHING READING IN ANOTHER LANGUAGE

Topic-005: Introduction to Learning to Read in another Language (I)

What did Krashen's 1985 research emphasize regarding reading in another language?

Focus on extensive reading and its benefits.

Why is it necessary for reading material to be more controlled in L2 learning?

To facilitate pre-teaching and promote effective methods of L2 vocabulary learning.

What recent research has shed light on reading fluency in L2 learning?

The importance of teachers focusing on the most useful words, direct instruction, extensive reading, and multiple exposures.

What should L2 learners do beyond simply translating texts?

Apply reading strategies and connect prior and existing knowledge.

What does Krashen's 1985 research suggest about the approach to reading in another language, and what concept is emphasized?

Krashen's 1985 research suggests that the approach to reading in another language should primarily focus on extensive reading. Extensive reading involves reading a large volume of material, and it emphasizes the benefits of reading as a method for language acquisition and learning. Krashen's idea is that learners can acquire language by engaging in extensive reading, as it exposes them to a wide

range of vocabulary and sentence structures in context. This approach emphasizes the importance of immersion and the natural acquisition of language through extensive exposure to texts.

Topic-006: Introduction to Learning to Read in another Language (II)

What is the key cognitive aspect that L2 students need to develop in English reading?

They need to learn how to think about texts in English.

According to cognitive psychologists, what should L2 students have conscious awareness of in their reading activities?

They should be aware of what they are doing in their reading process.

What is the cognitive aspect that L2 students need to develop when learning to read in English, and why is it important?

L2 students need to develop the cognitive skill of thinking in English when learning to read in the language. This cognitive aspect is crucial because it enables students to engage with texts in a way that is more natural and effective. When students think in English, they are better able to understand the text, as they do not rely on constant translation from their native language. This ability to think in the target language is a key step in achieving reading fluency and comprehension.

Topic-007: Principles for Teaching Reading: Meaning-Focused Input

What is the main focus of meaning-focused input in L2 reading instruction?

Understanding and gaining knowledge through reading.

Why is it important for learners to be interested in the input in meaning-focused reading?

Interest enhances the quality of reading and comprehension.

Which theory by Krashen is associated with meaning-focused input in L2 learning?

Krashen's (1985) input theory, which emphasizes meaningful comprehensible input as the source of L2 learning.

What is the primary focus of meaning-focused input in the context of L2 reading instruction, and why is this focus significant?

The primary focus of meaning-focused input in L2 reading instruction is on understanding and gaining knowledge through reading. This focus is significant because it aligns with the idea that language learning should be meaningful and purposeful. When learners engage with texts to understand their content and gain knowledge, they are more motivated and engaged. This focus encourages learners to see the relevance and utility of the language they are learning, making the learning process more meaningful and enjoyable.

Topic-008: Principles For Teaching Reading: Meaning-Focused Output

What does meaning-focused output involve in L2 learning?

Learning through speaking and writing productively.

How should reading be related to other language skills in L2 instruction?

The course should involve listening, speaking, and writing activities related to reading.

What is the primary goal of meaning-focused output in reading?

Conveying the message to someone else.

According to Swain's (1985) output hypothesis, what should learners do to learn the L2 effectively?

They should produce L2 and consciously notice gaps in their knowledge.

Topic-009: Principles for Teaching Reading: Language-Focused Learning

What skills should learners be helped to develop in L2 reading?

Sub-skills needed for reading, such as phonemic awareness, phonics, spelling, vocabulary, and grammar.

What reading activities and strategies should L2 learners engage in according to language-focused learning?

Activities like previewing, setting a purpose, predicting, posing questions, connecting to background knowledge, and more.

Topic-010: Principles for Teaching Reading: Fluency Development

What is the primary objective in fluency development in L2 reading?

Developing fluency in reading by practicing with familiar material.

How can extensive reading be encouraged in L2 learning?

By motivating learners with interesting texts and monitoring their extensive reading.

Why is processing L2 features in deep and thoughtful ways important in reading courses?

It helps raise consciousness and aids in later learning.

What activities can help develop reading fluency, as mentioned in the lesson?

Speed reading, repeated reading, paired reading, scanning, and skimming.

Lesson-03

TEACHING HOW TO RECOGNIZE AND SPELL WORDS I

Topic-011: Teaching How to Recognize & Spell Words: Introduction

What is the skill discussed in this introduction?

The skill of recognizing written forms, connecting them with spoken form and their meanings.

What is the significance of recognizing known words and deciphering unfamiliar words?

It is important for effective reading and language comprehension.

What is the position taken in this course regarding word recognition teaching?

The course emphasizes a balance of four strands in teaching word recognition.

What are the principles that should guide formal word recognition instruction?

Paying attention to rules and items that occur frequently, keeping it simple and regular.

What position does this course take regarding teaching word recognition, and what are the principles that should guide this teaching?

This course advocates for a balanced approach, incorporating four strands in teaching word recognition. The principles that should guide this teaching include paying attention to rules and items that occur frequently, keeping the teaching simple and regular. This balanced approach ensures that learners can effectively recognize and spell words while understanding the underlying principles of language.

Topic-012: Prerequisites for Formal Reading Instruction

What components are discussed as prerequisites for effective reading instruction?

Phonemic awareness, explicit instruction in sound identification, phonics knowledge, vocabulary, text comprehension, written expression, and motivation.

Why is adequate fluency important for comprehension?

Adequate fluency is important because it allows readers to focus on comprehension instead of struggling with word recognition.

What is the role of vocabulary in text comprehension?

Vocabulary knowledge is critical to comprehension, and text comprehension depends on a large working vocabulary.

How can teachers enhance text comprehension?

Teachers can ensure that readers understand what they are reading, provide effective instruction, and motivate students.

What are some of the components discussed as prerequisites for effective reading instruction, and why are they important?

Several components are discussed as prerequisites for effective reading instruction. These include phonemic awareness, explicit instruction in sound identification, phonics knowledge, vocabulary, text comprehension, written expression, and motivation. These components are important because they collectively build a strong foundation for reading skills, ensuring that learners can decode words, comprehend text, and express themselves effectively.

Why is fluency in word recognition important, and how does it relate to comprehension?

Fluency in word recognition is essential because it allows readers to recognize words automatically, which, in turn, frees up cognitive resources for understanding and comprehending the text. When readers don't have to struggle with word recognition, they can focus on the meaning and context of the material, which is critical for comprehension.

Topic-013: Prerequisites for Formal Reading Instruction: Phonemic Awareness

What is the focus of phonemic awareness activities?

Phonemic awareness activities focus on the sounds of words, not on letters or spelling.

How can phonemes be made prominent in phonemic awareness activities?

Learners can be asked to produce each sound in isolation until they understand its nature.

Provide an example of a phonemic awareness activity.

for the initial /s/ sound in words like "sat," "sit," and "sad."

Why is it important to make phonemic awareness a top priority?

It is important because it lays the foundation for reading and language skills.

What strategies can be used to teach phonemic awareness, and why is it essential to make phonemes prominent?

Strategies for teaching phonemic awareness include asking learners to produce each sound in isolation and focusing on the sounds of words rather than letters or

spelling. It is essential to make phonemes prominent because it helps learners understand the nature of individual sounds within words, which is critical for reading and language development.

Provide an example of a phonemic awareness activity and explain its significance.

An example of a phonemic awareness activity is asking learners to listen for the initial /s/ sound in words like "sat," "sit," and "sad." This activity is significant because it helps learners identify and recognize the individual sounds within words, which is a fundamental skill for word recognition and reading.

Topic-014: Prerequisites for Formal Reading Instruction: Spoken Language & Reading

What is the "experience approach" to reading?

The experience approach suggests that learners should bring their own experiences and knowledge to reading to help them learn new information.

How can learners create their personal reading books?

Learners create personal reading books by drawing pictures, describing them, and practicing reading the descriptions to others.

Where is most of the knowledge needed to read and comprehend text found?

Most of the knowledge needed for reading and comprehension is within the reader's own experiences.

Describe the steps involved in the "experience approach" to reading.

In the "experience approach," learners follow these steps:

Each learner draws a picture illustrating something they know or have experienced.

Learners take their pictures to the teacher, who asks what the picture is about.

The teacher writes a description based on what the learner said, using the same words, even if it is non-standard English.

This description becomes the learner's text for the day, and they read it back to the teacher.

Learners take the description away to practice reading it to classmates, friends, and family.

These pictures and texts are gathered to create a personal reading book.

Topic-015: Phonics and the Alphabetic Principle

Why is sound symbol knowledge important for accurate and fluent word recognition?

It is important because it allows readers to decode and understand unknown words.

What does "phonics knowledge" go beyond knowing?

It goes beyond knowing the names of letters and includes an understanding of the purpose of letters.

What are some activities that engage learners in recognizing letters visually?

Engaging activities include recognizing letters visually, helping students form letters, and teaching them to attend to the sounds of language.

What does playing games with words, syllables, and rhymes help students develop?

Playing games with words, syllables, and rhymes helps students develop phonemic awareness.

What are some activities that engage learners in recognizing letters visually, and why is this important for reading instruction?

Engaging learners in activities to recognize letters visually can include recognizing letters, helping them form letters, and teaching them how to attend to the sounds or phonology of the language. This is important because it develops students' visual recognition skills and their awareness of the sounds of individual words, which are essential for word recognition and reading. It helps learners connect the visual and auditory aspects of language.

Lesson-04

TEACHING HOW TO RECOGNIZE AND SPELL WORDS II

Topic 016: The Role of Phonics in a Reading Program

How does familiarity with what is being read help word recognition?

Familiarity with what is being read helps word recognition by making it easier to recognize words as complete units.

What does phonics involve in reading?

Phonics involves spelling-sound relationships, which are significant for both learning to read and learning to spell.

How can phonics be used to read specially chosen isolated words?

Phonics can be used to read specially chosen isolated words by teaching the spelling-sound relationships of those words.

How can phonics fit into reading instruction with known words?

Phonics can be introduced by associating it with known words to make the learning process more effective.

What is the significance of teaching the most frequent, simple, regular spelling-sound correspondences?

Teaching the most frequent, simple, regular spelling-sound correspondences helps learners decode words more effectively.

Topic 017: Spelling: Productive Phonics I Significance

What is the receptive skill of reading related to spelling-sound correspondences?

The receptive skill of reading is related to being familiar with spelling-sound correspondences.

How is spelling related to the skill of writing?

Spelling is part of the skill of writing.

How does deliberate learning play a role in vocabulary and grammar acquisition?

Deliberate learning plays a secondary indirect role in vocabulary and grammar acquisition.

Topic 018: Spelling: Productive Phonics: System & Item Learning

What is the major obstacle to learning to spell in English?

The unpredictability of the English spelling system is a major obstacle to learning to spell.

How does phonological awareness affect spelling and reading?

Phonological awareness affects both spelling and reading, and it has long-term effects.

What are some strategies poor spellers use in writing?

Poor spellers often use avoidance strategies in their writing.

Topic 019: First Language Effects on Second Language Reading

How can L1 knowledge affect L2 learning?

L1 knowledge can strongly affect L2 learning, with similarities between the languages making the L2 learning process easier.

What elements do successful L1 and L2 readers engage in to comprehend text?

A: Successful L1 and L2 readers consciously or unconsciously engage in specific behaviors involving the reader, text, and interaction to comprehend text.

Topic 020: Learning to Spell and its Significance for Teaching Reading (I)

Why is English spelling considered difficult?

English spelling is considered difficult due to its mix of rules and irregularities.

What are the four strands involved in dealing with spelling?

The four strands involved in dealing with spelling are spelling and input, spelling and output, spelling and learning, and spelling and teaching.

Topic 021: Learning to Spell and its Significance for Teaching Reading (II)

What are some techniques for teaching spelling?

Techniques for teaching spelling include deliberate memorization, using analogies, pronouncing words as spelled, visualizing, and noticing patterns.

What is the significance of strategy training in spelling?

Strategy training involves memorizing new items, finding the spelling of needed words, and learning how to pronounce new words when reading.

Topic 022: Designing a Focused Spelling Program for Reading

What are some features of a good intensive spelling program?

Features of a good intensive spelling program include keeping learners motivated, giving quick feedback, conducting mastery testing, making learning fun, encouraging thoughtful processing, planning for repetition and revision, training learners in strategies, and fostering reflection on learning.

Lesson-05

Sir Zahid

TEACHING INTENSIVE EFL/ESL READING

I

Topic 023: Introduction to Intensive EFL/ESL Reading

What is the significance of intensive EFL/ESL reading?

It involves reading in detail for specific aims and tasks.

How does extensive reading differ from intensive reading?

Extensive reading is for enjoyment and general reading skills, while intensive reading involves specific tasks.

What are some classroom intensive reading activities?

Activities include skimming a text for specific information to answer true or false statements, filling gaps in a summary, and scanning text to match headings to paragraphs.

What is the classic approach to teaching intensive reading?

The classic approach is the Grammar-Translation Method (GTM), which determines what language features will get attention.

Topic 024: Focuses in Intensive Reading

What are the key aspects of intensive reading?

Intensive reading focuses on comprehension, sound-spelling relations, vocabulary, grammar, cohesion, and information structure.

What are the key aspects or focuses of intensive reading?

Intensive reading encompasses several key aspects that are essential for the development of language skills and comprehension. These aspects include:

Comprehension: The primary objective of intensive reading is to enhance learners' understanding of a particular text. This involves a close examination of the content and structure of the text to grasp its meaning.

Regular and Irregular Sound-Spelling Relations: Intensive reading also addresses the complexities of sound-spelling relations in the language. Learners are exposed to phonics, spelling rules, and reading aloud as strategies to improve their grasp of both regular and irregular sound-spelling relationships.

Vocabulary: The intensive reading approach places significant emphasis on vocabulary development. Learners are encouraged to pay attention to useful words and explore the underlying meanings of words within the context of the text.

Grammar: The study of grammar is an integral part of intensive reading. Learners analyze the grammatical structures used in the text to enhance their language skills.

Cohesion: Understanding how various elements within a text are interconnected and cohesive is another key focus. This involves recognizing how sentences and ideas link together for a cohesive reading experience.

Information Structure: Intensive reading delves into the structure of information in texts, such as specific kinds of information presentation. An example of this can be seen in newspaper reports, which often explain what happened, how it occurred, and its effects. Additionally, learners are exposed to genre features, which explore how a text achieves its communicative purpose through vocabulary, grammatical features, and cohesive features that are specific to the genre.

Topic 025: Features of a Good Intensive Reading Exercise

What should a good intensive reading exercise focus on?

It should focus on items and strategies that can be applied to any text.

Why is it important for a reading exercise to provide useful feedback?

Useful feedback helps learners understand what they need to do differently if they are not successful on some parts of the exercise.

What are the essential features of a good intensive reading exercise?

A good intensive reading exercise is designed to focus on specific items and strategies that can be applied to any text. It should exhibit several features that contribute to its effectiveness:

Items and Strategies: The exercise should focus on both specific items and strategies that are applicable to a wide range of texts. These items and strategies enable learners to develop a skill set that can be employed when encountering various texts.

Universal Applicability: A well-designed exercise is not limited to a single text but can be used with any text. This universality ensures that learners can apply the acquired skills to a broad spectrum of reading materials.

Directing Attention: An effective exercise directs learners' attention to various features of the text. This includes strategies for dealing with any text, thereby

fostering an understanding of the language and ways of engaging with language, rather than solely focusing on the message conveyed.

Part-Text Analysis: The exercise involves analyzing parts of the text in relation to its wider context. This requires learners to consider information from outside the text and understand how it connects to the text's content.

Useful Feedback: The exercise should provide useful information about learners' performance. If learners encounter difficulties with specific sections, the feedback should guide them on how to approach these challenges differently. This feedback is instrumental in their learning process.

These features collectively contribute to the effectiveness of intensive reading exercises in building comprehension and language skills.

Topic 026: Are Comprehension Questions Good For Reading Exercise? (I) **Usefulness**

What is the usefulness of comprehension questions in reading exercises?

Comprehension questions are an effective technique for training in reading and can take various forms, such as yes/no questions, true/false statements, multiple choice items, and blank-filling exercises.

What can simple comprehension questions help check?

Simple comprehension questions can help check vocabulary, sentence structure, inference, and supposition.

Why should comprehension questions be local rather than general?

Local comprehension questions focus on specific aspects of the text, such as the message of a particular text or the interpretation of modal verbs.

Topic 027: Are Comprehension Questions Good For Reading Exercise? (II) **Usefulness**

How do comprehension questions direct learners' attention to the reading text?

Comprehension questions make learners consider more than one sentence to answer the question and ensure that the text must be read.

Why is it important to pre-test comprehension questions?

Pre-testing ensures that learners cannot answer the questions without reading the text and helps identify causes of errors.

Why can making comprehension questions be challenging?

Creating comprehension questions is challenging because it requires specific skills, time, and effort.

How can comprehension questions be useful for practicing reading and motivating learners to read?

Comprehension questions are useful for practicing reading and can motivate learners by stimulating discussion and encouraging them to find the right answers while avoiding similar errors through feedback.

Working on the Next Lessons

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